

Conflict in the Middle East

Key Topic 1: The Birth of the State of Israel (1945-63)

Student Workbook



Name: _____

Class: _____

Specification Checklist & Inquiries

Done	Key Topic 1: The Birth of the State of Israel (1945-63)	Core Inquiry Question
☐	Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.	<i>Why were the conflicting demands impossible for the British to resolve?</i>
☐	Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.	<i>How did violence and international pressure force the British to withdraw?</i>
☐	The War of 1948-49 and its impact on the development of the State of Israel, the status of Jerusalem, and the creation of the Palestinian refugee problem.	<i>How did the 1948-49 war transform the Middle East?</i>

TOPIC 1.1: BRITISH WITHDRAWAL & CREATION OF ISRAEL

CURRICULUM SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST (PEARSON EDEXCEL)

- ☐ Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

Bevin Cabinet Memo (Jan 1947)

"We are bearing the entire military and financial burden of keeping the peace in Palestine, while being subjected to constant abuse... Our forces are targeted daily, and the cost of maintaining 100,000 troops is crippling our post-war economic recovery... We must refer this matter to the UN."

Irgun Communiqué (July 1946)

"We targeted the British military headquarters to make it clear that the occupier cannot reside in peace. The King David Hotel was warned, but the authorities refused to evacuate, leading to this tragic, necessary cost of liberation."

Ben-Gurion's Diary (July 1948)

"The ceasefire was a godsend. It gave us the precious weeks we needed to coordinate our defense under a single flag, consolidate our forces into the IDF, and bring in the modern equipment from Czechoslovakia needed to secure our borders."

Arab Higher Committee Statement (1947)

"Palestine is an Arab country. The United Nations has no right to partition our land against the will of its majority, giving 55% of the territory to a minority that represents only 33% of the population."

Zionism Movement advocating for an independent Jewish homeland in Palestine.

Certificates Official entry permits issued by mandate authorities.

Insurgency Coordinated armed rebellion against a ruling state power.

Mandate League of Nations authorization for Britain to govern the territory.

King David Hotel British military administrative headquarters bombed in July 1946 (91 deaths).

Sergeants Affair Retaliatory hanging of two British sergeants by Irgun, breaking UK domestic resolve.

SS Exodus Refugee ship turned away by Britain in 1947, provoking global outcry.

Resolution 181 The 1947 United Nations partition framework.

Deir Yassin Palestinian village attacked by Zionist paramilitaries in April 1948, triggering widespread panic.

Sovereignty Independent authority and supreme self-governing power.

Bevin Quota The strict monthly limit of 1,500 Jewish immigrants to protect relations with Arab oil nations.

Nakba 'Catastrophe'; the displacement of 700,000 Palestinians.

1. Why did Jewish demands clash with British policy in 1945?

Following the Allied victory in 1945, Britain faced a mounting crisis in Palestine. The Holocaust galvanized global support for **Zionism**—the movement advocating for a sovereign Jewish homeland. In the US, President Harry Truman pressured British PM Clement Attlee to immediately grant entry **certificates** for 100,000 Jewish refugees. Meanwhile, Palestinian Arabs, led by the Grand Mufti **Haj Amin al-Husseini**, vehemently opposed this, demanding immediate independence and warning of rebellion. Caught in the middle, British Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin restricted immigration to a quota of **1,500** per month to protect relations with Arab oil-producing nations, fueling deep anger among Jewish communities. The British were effectively caught between their desperate need for Arab oil to rebuild their shattered post-war economy, and intense moral and political pressure from the US to help the Jewish refugees.

2. How did Zionist paramilitaries force the British out?

Furious at British restrictions, Jewish paramilitary organizations (Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi) launched a coordinated armed **insurgency**. On 22 July 1946, the Irgun bombed the British military administrative headquarters at the King David Hotel in Jerusalem, killing 91 people. The crisis escalated in July 1947 with the **Sergeants Affair**: the Irgun kidnapped and hanged two British sergeants (Clifford Martin and Mervyn Paice) in retaliation for British executions. This caused immense public outrage in Britain, sparked anti-Semitic riots, and destroyed domestic willingness to maintain the Mandate. The British public, exhausted from World War II and facing severe economic rationing at home, increasingly viewed the Palestine Mandate as a massive drain on blood and treasure.

3. Why did UN Resolution 181 fail to prevent war?

In July 1947, British authorities intercepted the **SS Exodus** carrying 4,500 Holocaust survivors and returned them to Europe, causing global media outrage. Near bankruptcy and unable to maintain order, Britain referred Palestine's future to the United Nations. On 29 November 1947, the UN passed **Resolution 181 (the Partition Plan)**, proposing to divide Palestine into separate Jewish and Arab states, with Jerusalem under international control. Jewish leaders accepted the plan for **sovereignty**, but Arab leaders rejected it as unjust, since the Jewish state got 55% of the land despite Jews representing only 33% of the population. Palestinian Arabs felt their right to self-determination was completely ignored by western powers, triggering civil war. During this escalating civil war, Zionist paramilitaries (Irgun and Lehi) attacked the Arab village of **Deir Yassin** on 9 April 1948, killing over 100 residents, which spread widespread panic and accelerated the flight of Palestinian civilians.

When the Mandate expired on 14 May 1948, David Ben-Gurion declared the State of Israel. British forces withdrew, and five neighboring Arab armies (Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Lebanon, Iraq) invaded. Israel won due to **Arab disunity** (lack of coordinated command); **military consolidation** (paramilitaries merged into the IDF); and a crucial ceasefire that allowed Israel to negotiate a secret arms deal with **Czechoslovakia**, doubling active troops from 35,000 to 108,000. By 1949, Israel

captured 50% more land than originally allocated, creating a refugee crisis for 700,000 Palestinians, known as the **Nakba**.

Historical Interpretations: Contrasting Views

Interpretation 1: Michael J. Cohen (Traditionalist / Pragmatic Imperial Focus)

"The British decision to abandon the Mandate was the inevitable result of an exhausted empire facing an insoluble conflict. Bankrupt after World War II and unable to police 100,000 troops in Palestine, Britain realized that maintaining control was economically and politically unsustainable, especially as the conflicting demands of Arabs and Jews reached a complete deadlock."

Interpretation 2: William Roger Louis (Revisionist / Insurgency Focus)

"It was the violent Zionist insurgency, rather than abstract imperial decline, that drove Britain out. The Irgun's campaign of terror—climaxing in the devastating bombing of the King David Hotel in 1946 and the retaliatory hanging of British sergeants—destroyed British public morale, humiliated the military command, and made the Mandate politically untenable."

Synthesis Tip: When writing about the end of the Mandate, consider whether British withdrawal was pushed by external pressures (Zionist insurgency) or pulled by internal decline (post-war financial crisis).

Knowledge Check Tasks

- 1. Insurgency Case Study: Map out the causal chain of the Zionist rebellion.
- 2. Partition Conflict: Contrast the Jewish and Arab reactions to UN Resolution 181.
- 3. Civil War Catalysts: Note the role of psychological warfare and the Deir Yassin attack.
- 4. War & Victory Analysis: Identify the three pillars of the Israeli military victory.

CORNELL NOTES • TOPIC 1.1: BRITISH WITHDRAWAL & CREATION OF ISRAEL



DO NOW: RECALL FROM PREVIOUS LESSON

Q1: What was the Balfour Declaration of 1917?

Q2: Which empire controlled Palestine before the British Mandate?

Q3: How did the Holocaust impact international sympathy for a Jewish state?

1. Conflicting Demands & Quotas (1945)

- What did Jews demand?
- What did Arabs demand?
- Why did Bevin limit migration to 1,500/mo?

Keywords:

Bevin quota, 1,500/month, Truman pressure, Arab oil security, Haj Amin al-Husseini

2. Zionist Insurgency (1946-47)

- King David Hotel bombing (91 deaths)
- Kidnapping of Clifford Martin & Mervyn Paice (Sergeants Affair)

Keywords:

Irgun strategy, King David Hotel, 91 fatalities, Sergeants Affair, Loss of domestic resolve

3. UN Referral & Resolution 181 (1947)

- SS Exodus incident
- UN land split (55% to 33% population)
- Conflicting Jewish/Arab reactions

Keywords:

SS Exodus, UN Resolution 181, 55% allocation, IDF consolidation, Czechoslovakia arms, Nakba

4. 1948 Arab-Israeli War

- IDF formation (Ben-Gurion)
- Arab disunity factors
- Czechoslovakia arms deal
- Palestinian refugee crisis (Nakba)

GCSE EXAM PRACTICE • TOPIC 1.1: BRITISH WITHDRAWAL & CREATION OF ISRAEL

 CURRICULUM SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST (PEARSON EDEXCEL)

- ☐ Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

Question 1 [8 Marks]

Explain two consequences of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946). (8 marks)

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.**CONSEQUENCE RUBRIC (4 MARKS)**

- ☐ [] **Point:** Clearly state one consequence of the event [1 Mark]
- ☐ [] **Detail:** Support with specific historical details (dates/names/key terms) [1 Mark]
- ☐ [] **Explanation:** Explain exactly how the consequence resulted from the event [2 Marks]

GCSE EXAM PRACTICE • TOPIC 1.1: BRITISH WITHDRAWAL & CREATION OF ISRAEL

Question 2 [8 Marks]

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948-49). (8 marks)

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NARRATIVE ACCOUNT RUBRIC (8 MARKS)

- ☐ [] **Sequence:** Structure the account in clear chronological order (Beginning → Middle → End) [2 Marks]
- ☐ [] **Linkage:** Use connection words (e.g. 'This led to', 'As a direct result') to link events [2 Marks]
- ☐ [] **Knowledge:** Support with precise historical details (dates, names, key terms) [2 Marks]

☐ [] **Analysis:** Explain how the chain of events led to the final outcome [2 Marks]

TOPIC 1.2: THE AFTERMATH OF THE 1948–49 WAR

CURRICULUM SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST (PEARSON EDEXCEL)

- ☐ Territorial changes and their impact.
- ☐ The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ The creation of the Israeli Defence Forces and the Law of Return.
- ☐ US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Israel's relations with Egypt.

UN Refugee Report (1949)

"Hundreds of thousands of Arab families are housed in makeshift tents without sanitation. The situation in the Gaza and West Bank areas requires immediate international intervention to avert total famine."

Israeli Government Statement (1950)

"This state will be open for Jewish immigration and for the Ingathering of the Exiles. It will promote the development of the country for the benefit of all its inhabitants."

Egyptian Radio Broadcast (1953)

"The Fedayeen will strike at the Zionist settlements day and night until our brothers' lands are returned. Let the enemy know there is no security on stolen land."

Knesset Security Memo (1954)

"We cannot tolerate constant incursions that slaughter our border families. Reprisals are our only defense. Furthermore, the Egyptian blockade of the Straits of Tiran is a clear act of war closing Eilat to our shipping."

Green Line The 1949 armistice borders separating Israel from its Arab neighbors.

Nakba Arabic for 'Catastrophe'; the flight and expulsion of 700,000 Palestinians.

UNRWA UN agency established in 1949 to provide food, health care, and schooling to Palestinian refugees.

Law of Return 1950 Israeli law granting automatic citizenship to any Jewish immigrant.

Tzena Strict economic austerity and food rationing system implemented in early 1950s Israel.

Conscription Compulsory military service introduced in Israel to maintain a massive reserve force.

Fedayeen Palestinian guerrilla fighters launching cross-border raids into Israel.

Reprisals Disproportionately harsh military counter-attacks launched by the IDF.

Suez Canal Waterway blockaded by Egypt to choke Israeli maritime commerce.

Straits of Tiran Narrow sea passage blockaded by Egypt to close off Israel's port of Eilat.

Count Bernadotte UN mediator assassinated in September 1948 by the Zionist Stern Gang.

Right of Return The right claimed by Palestinian refugees to return to their original homes, denied by Israel.

1. How did the 1948-49 war transform the map of Palestine?

The armistice agreements of 1949 redrew the map of the Middle East. The proposed independent Palestinian Arab state was aborted. Israel captured **79%** of mandate Palestine (50% more than the UN partition plan had allocated), gaining control of vast new territories including the fertile **Galilee** region, the **Negev Desert**, and **West Jerusalem**. Transjordan occupied the **West Bank** and East Jerusalem, annexing it in 1951, while Egypt took military control of the **Gaza Strip**. These armistice lines became known as the **Green Line**, consolidating Israel's victories and entrenching border divisions.

2. What caused the Palestinian refugee crisis?

The war was a disaster for Palestinian Arabs, who refer to the events of 1948 as the **Nakba** ('The Catastrophe'). Over **700,000** Palestinians fled or were forcibly expelled from their homes in the territory that became Israel. Fleeing in panic, they ended up in squalid, overcrowded refugee camps in Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon, Syria, and Jordan. Israel denied them the **Right of Return** to prevent the dilution of its Jewish majority, creating permanent exile. In December 1949, the UN established the **UNRWA** (Relief and Works Agency) to manage these camps and provide basic food, healthcare, and schooling.

3. How did Israel secure its new state?

To defend the new state, Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion merged rival pre-war Jewish militias (Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi) into a single national army: the **Israeli Defence Forces (IDF)**. Israel introduced universal conscription to secure its borders. In July 1950, Israel passed the **Law of Return**, granting every Jew in the world the right to settle in Israel and receive immediate citizenship. This doubled Israel's population in three years, welcoming Holocaust survivors and Jews fleeing Arab lands. This massive influx caused extreme economic strain, forcing a strict food rationing system called **Tzena** and heavy reliance on US aid (grants and loans totaling **\$300 million**) and German reparations.

4. Why did tensions between Israel and Egypt remain high?

Following the war, relations between Israel and Egypt were characterized by deep hostility. Egypt resented Israel for its military defeat and for the burden of 200,000 Palestinian refugees trapped in the Egyptian-controlled Gaza Strip. Displaced Palestinians, known as the **Fedayeen**, launched frequent guerrilla raids from Gaza into Israel. The IDF responded with disproportionate military **reprisals**, escalating border tensions. Egypt also waged economic war by blockading the **Suez Canal** to Israeli shipping and closing the **Straits of Tiran**, choking Israel's southern port of Eilat.

Interpretation 1: Efraim Karsh (Traditionalist Israeli Interpretation)

"The flight of Palestinian Arabs in 1948 was largely voluntary, driven by the collapse of local leadership and explicit instructions from Arab commanders. They urged the population to leave temporarily to clear the path for the invading Arab armies, promising a swift return once the Jewish state was destroyed. There was no pre-conceived Zionist plan to expel them."

Interpretation 2: Benny Morris (Revisionist 'New Historian' Interpretation)

"The Palestinian refugee crisis was born of war, not of design. While there was no systematic, pre-planned Zionist master plan for expulsion, the flight was primarily triggered by direct military actions of the Haganah/IDF, fear of incoming clashes, psychological warfare, and localized, deliberate expulsions by commanders on the ground, such as at Lydda and Ramle."

Synthesis Tip: GCSE questions on the aftermath of the 1948 war require you to analyze the refugee crisis. Contrast these views to show that historians debate whether displacement was a deliberate policy or a chaotic byproduct of war.

Knowledge Check Tasks

- 1. Border Division: Map the territorial changes. Detail the Green Line, Israeli gains (79%), and who took Gaza and the West Bank.
- 2. Refugee Crisis: Detail the Nakba. State the number of refugees (700,000) and the role of UNRWA.
- 3. Consolidation Pillars: Explain the IDF unification and the Law of Return. Include the Tzena economic strain.
- 4. Border Hostility: Detail the Fedayeen-reprisal cycle and Egypt's economic blockade of the Suez Canal/Straits of Tiran.

CORNELL NOTES • TOPIC 1.2: THE AFTERMATH OF THE 1948–49 WAR

 DO NOW: RECALL FROM PREVIOUS LESSON

- Q1:** Which five Arab nations invaded Israel in May 1948?
-
- Q2:** From which country did Israel secure weapons during the 1948 UN truce?
-
- Q3:** What was UN Resolution 181?
-

1. Borders & Territory (1949)

- What was the Green Line?
- How much land did Israel control?
- Who took Gaza and the West Bank?

Keywords:
Green Line, 79% Israeli control, West Bank annexed by Jordan, Gaza under Egypt

2. The Nakba & UNRWA (1949)

- What was the Nakba?
- How many refugees were displaced?
- What was the role of UNRWA?

Keywords:
700,000 displaced, UNRWA camps, Right of Return denied, Nakba

3. State Consolidation & Aid - What did the Law of Return do? - Why did Ben-Gurion merge militias? - What was Tzena? Keywords: Law of Return, IDF conscription, Tzena rationing, US financial aid, Count Bernadotte	
4. Egypt-Israel Tensions - Who were the Fedayeen? - What was the reprisal cycle? - What blockades did Egypt launch? Keywords: Fedayeen raids, IDF reprisals, Suez & Tiran blockade, Eilat port choked	

GCSE EXAM PRACTICE • TOPIC 1.2: THE AFTERMATH OF THE 1948–49 WAR

 CURRICULUM SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST (PEARSON EDEXCEL)

- ☐ Territorial changes and their impact.
- ☐ The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ The creation of the Israeli Defence Forces and the Law of Return.
- ☐ US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Israel's relations with Egypt.

Question 1 [8 Marks]

Explain two consequences of the 1948-49 Arab-Israeli War. (8 marks)

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TOPIC 1.3: THE SUEZ CRISIS

CURRICULUM SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST (PEARSON EDEXCEL)

- ☐ Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- ☐ The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- ☐ The events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the UAR in 1958.

Nasser Speech (July 1956)

"We shall build the Aswan Dam ourselves. The Suez Canal belongs to Egypt, run by Egyptian hands. The revenue of the Canal will fund our national independence and modernization."

Eden Commons Speech (1956)

"Nasser cannot be allowed to have his thumb on our windpipe. The Canal is an international highway, and we cannot trust a fascist dictator with the freedom of navigation."

President Eisenhower Letter (Nov 1956)

"This action has been taken without our knowledge. We cannot support the use of force to settle this dispute. Britain must comply with the UN ceasefire, or we will block IMF loans."

Protocol of Sèvres (Oct 1956)

"The Israeli forces will launch a large-scale attack on Egyptian forces in Sinai. The British and French governments will then appeal to both combatants to withdraw from the Canal, landing troops to secure navigation."

Pan-Arabism Ideology promoting the unification of Arab nations under common political leadership.

Czech Arms Deal 1955 agreement providing Egypt with advanced Soviet jet fighters and tanks.

Aswan Dam Massive Egyptian infrastructure project which lost Western funding, prompting canal seizure.

Nationalisation The act of bringing private assets (the Suez Canal) under government ownership.

Protocol of Sèvres Secret agreement outlining the military collusion between Britain, France, and Israel.

Sinai Peninsula Vast desert territory captured by Israel during the swift October campaign.

Port Said Egyptian canal city where British and French paratroopers landed.

UNEF First UN peacekeeping force, deployed in Sinai to separate Egyptian and Israeli forces.

UAR The 1958 political union between Egypt and Syria, representing the height of Pan-Arabism.

Eisenhower US President who forced the withdrawal of invading forces using financial leverage.

Austerity Severe economic cuts, experienced in Egypt due to dam expenses and invasion damages.

Pan-Arab hero Nasser's status after surviving the invasion and retaining nationalised control of the canal.

1. How did Nasser threaten Western interests in the Middle East?

Gamal Abdel Nasser came to power in Egypt in 1954, championing **Pan-Arabism**—the unification of Arab states to resist Western influence and oppose Israel. To modernize his army and bypass Western restrictions, Nasser signed the **Czech Arms Deal** in September 1955, importing modern Soviet jet fighters and tanks. This deal fundamentally shifted the regional balance of power. He also planned to construct the massive **Aswan High Dam** to boost Egypt's economy.

2. Why did Britain, France, and Israel form a secret alliance?

When the US and UK withdrew their funding for the Aswan Dam in July 1956, Nasser retaliated by nationalising the British-and-French-owned **Suez Canal** to fund the project. Outraged, Britain and France signed the secret **Protocol of Sèvres** with Israel. The conspiracy was simple: Israel would invade Egypt, and Britain and France would intervene as 'peacekeepers' to seize control of the canal zone.

3. How did the Suez Crisis unfold militarily?

On 29 October 1956, Israel launched a swift invasion of the **Sinai Peninsula**, routing Egyptian forces. As planned, Britain and France ordered both sides to withdraw from the canal, and then bombed Egyptian airfields and landed troops at **Port Said**. While the invasion was a military success, capturing Sinai and the canal, it was a massive political disaster.

4. Why did the superpowers force an end to the crisis?

Angry at the unilateral action, US President Dwight Eisenhower threatened to destroy the British **pound** by selling US sterling reserves and blocking IMF loans. The USSR threatened rocket strikes. Under this intense pressure, Britain, France, and Israel withdrew. A UN peacekeeping force (**UNEF**) was deployed to Sinai. Nasser emerged as a Pan-Arab hero, leading to the peak of Pan-Arabism in 1958 with the **UAR** (United Arab Republic), a political union between Egypt and Syria.

Historical Interpretations: Contrasting Views

Interpretation 1: Jean-Edward Smith (Traditional Western / Treaty-Based Focus)

"Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal Company was a unilateral act of aggression that violated international trust and threatened the free passage of global shipping. By seizing an asset built by Western capital and vital for European oil imports, Egypt forced Britain and France to intervene to protect their legal rights and the international rules-based order."

Interpretation 2: Fawaz Gerges (Post-Colonial / Arab Nationalist Focus)

"The nationalisation was a legitimate assertion of Egyptian national sovereignty and a blow against imperialist exploitation. The Canal was dug on Egyptian soil by Egyptian peasants, yet its profits flowed exclusively to foreign shareholders. Nasser's action was a bold, necessary step to finance national development and resist Western colonial dictates."

Synthesis Tip: The Suez Crisis is a classic study of conflicting perspectives. Explain how Western historians focus on international trade laws and treaty violations, while Arab historians highlight

Knowledge Check Tasks

- 1. Nasser's Policy: Outline Nasser's aims (Pan-Arabism) and explain why he signed the 1955 Czech Arms Deal.
- 2. Nationalisation Spark: Detail the Aswan Dam funding collapse and the nationalisation of the Suez Canal.
- 3. Sèvres Conspiracy: Explain the secret Protocol of Sèvres and how the tripartite invasion was coordinated.
- 4. Superpower Clash: Analyze how US economic threats and USSR warnings forced a ceasefire and withdrawal.

CORNELL NOTES • TOPIC 1.3: THE SUEZ CRISIS

 DO NOW: RECALL FROM PREVIOUS LESSON

- Q1:** What was the 'Green Line' established in 1949?
-
- Q2:** How many Palestinian refugees fled their homes in 1948?
-
- Q3:** Which Arab state took control of the West Bank after the 1948 war?
-

1. Nasser's Realignment - What was Nasser's ideology? - Why Czech Arms Deal (1955)? - What sparked canal seizure? Keywords: Pan-Arabism, Soviet Czech arms deal, Aswan Dam funding collapse	
2. The Secret Coalition - What was Sèvres Protocol? - When was Sinai invaded? - How did UK/France land? Keywords: Nationalisation, Sèvres Protocol, Tripartite Sinai/Port Said attack	

3. Superpower Pressures - Why did US oppose invasion? - What was US financial threat? - What was the UN response? Keywords: Eisenhower loan threats, Soviet rocket warnings, forced withdrawal	
4. Aftermath & UAR - How did Nasser's status change? - What was UAR (1958)? - How did UAR affect Israel? Keywords: UNEF deployment, Nasser Pan-Arab hero, 1958 UAR formation	

GCSE EXAM PRACTICE • TOPIC 1.3: THE SUEZ CRISIS

 CURRICULUM SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST (PEARSON EDEXCEL)

- Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- The events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the UAR in 1958.

Question 1 [8 Marks]

Explain two causes of the Suez Crisis (1956). (8 marks)

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SELF-EVALUATION RUBRIC

- ☐ [] Answered in full, grammatically correct sentences.
- ☐ [] Included specific historical details (dates, names, events).
- ☐ [] Explained the connection between cause and consequence or narrative progression.

GCSE EXAM PRACTICE • TOPIC 1.3: THE SUEZ CRISIS

Question 2 [8 Marks]

Explain the significance of the Suez Crisis (1956) for the Middle East. (8 marks)

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SELF-EVALUATION RUBRIC

- ☐ [] Answered in full, grammatically correct sentences.
- ☐ [] Included specific historical details (dates, names, events).
- ☐ [] Explained the connection between cause and consequence or narrative progression.

KT1 EXAM PRACTICE BANK

Consequence (4 Marks)

Question: Explain one consequence of the Zionist insurgency for British mandate control.

Question: Explain one consequence of the Israeli Law of Return (1950).

Question: Explain one consequence of the nationalisation of the Suez Canal (1956).

Narrative (8 Marks)

Question: Write a narrative account of the events of 1947–48 leading to the outbreak of the first Arab–Israeli War.

You may use the following in your answer: • The SS Exodus (1947) • UN Resolution 181

Importance (16 Marks)

Question: Explain the importance of the Palestinian refugee crisis for Arab–Israeli relations in the years 1948–56.

You may use the following in your answer: • Fedayeen raids • UNRWA camps

Question: Explain the importance of the Suez Crisis (1956) for Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.

You may use the following in your answer: • Protocol of Sèvres • United Arab Republic (UAR)